Varvara Puzrina

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EDUCATION

Boston University, College of Arts and Sciences — Boston, MA
B.S. in Computer Science and Economics (joint major); Minor in Business Administration — *Expected May 2028*
Honors: Dean's List
Relevant Coursework: Empirical Economics I & II (EC 203/204), Intermediate Microeconomics (EC 201), Intermediate Macroeconomics (EC 202), Intro to Computer Science I – Python (CS 111), Intro to Computer Science II – Java (CS 112, intensive section CS 392 XI)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

National Bureau of Economic Research (NBER) — Boston, MA
Research Assistant, Racial Expulsions in the U.S. (Prof. M. Fiszbein, BU & Prof. A. Ferrara, U. Pittsburgh) — *Mar 2026 – Present*
- Run **regression analyses in Stata, R, and Python** on the project dataset after being selected for the analysis stage
- Classified **5,000+ historical newspaper articles** (300–600 weekly) against a detailed coding rubric, separating confirmed from potential expulsions and recording location, violence, and fatalities
- Built structured, analysis-ready records for a **multi-university team of 12+ RAs** (BU, UT Austin, Tulane)

Boston University, Department of Economics — Boston, MA
Grant-Funded Research Assistant (PhD researcher A. Vyshinskiy), 1892–93 Cholera in Imperial Russia — *Aug 2026 – Present*
- Run regressions in **Stata and R** on a district-level panel, merging our newly digitized data with an MIT famine dataset (harvests, taxes, serfdom) to study cholera outcomes
- Built a monthly mortality panel for **16 provinces over 1888–1893 (72 months each)** plus 1892 medical-capacity data, digitized from scanned Imperial statistical yearbooks
- QA-checked every table against row/column totals, corrected source errors, and built a crosswalk between two district-coding systems so datasets could be merged

Boston University, CAS Directed Study Program — Boston, MA
Independent Researcher (Advisor: Prof. Onur Celik), Gender Gap in College Athlete NIL Compensation — *Sep 2026 – Present*
- Wrote an original empirical research proposal, approved by the department chair, on the gender gap in Name, Image, Likeness (NIL) pay among **NCAA Division I basketball players**, a market where men reportedly earn ~10x more
- Collecting a cross-section of **men's and women's D-I players** that matches On3 NIL valuations to 2025–26 season statistics, with rules for missing data and a top-1% outlier check
- Reviewed **9 core studies** (Becker; Blau & Kahn; Kahn & Sherer) and designed the empirical strategy: **OLS in R** (levels and logs) with **5 controls** and a female × followers interaction

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Yandex — Moscow, Russia
Research Intern, International Marketing Department — *Jun 2025 – Aug 2025*
- Authored market-entry report **"E-commerce Market of Uzbekistan: Barriers and Opportunities,"** adopted by the department
- Designed and led interviews with **19 SMB owners**, surveyed **60+ consumers,** and benchmarked **8 e-commerce platforms** to map demand patterns and entry barriers
- Performed revenue analysis of local competitors and compiled statistical summaries for department leadership

CarPot (www.carpot.com) — Boston, MA
Marketing & Analytics Intern, car-repair marketplace startup — *May 2026 – Jul 2026*
- Analyzed **website and app performance data** (traffic, acquisition, engagement) and reported insights to the founders
- Benchmarked competing car-repair platforms on pricing, fee models (subscription vs. per-job), and acquisition to sharpen positioning of the **iOS and Android app**
- Researched Boston-area demand and customer segments for both sides of the marketplace (car owners and mechanics)

LEADERSHIP & ACTIVITIES

Russian Speaking Society, Boston University — Boston, MA
Senior Treasurer — *May 2025 – Present*
- Manage a **$3,000–$4,000 semester budget**; planned budgets for 3 flagship events of **40–50 attendees** each
- Process **~20 reimbursements per semester** and report expenses to the university finance office, ensuring full policy compliance

BU AdClub Varsity Team – Project Manager: led a **7-person team**'s campaign project for a real client, **The Half Cookie**
Saxbys – Host, Spring 2026: counted cash revenue and closed out the register at end of shift
BU Hillel – Volunteering Team Member; **Girls Who Code** – Member

SKILLS

Data & Analytics: R, Stata, Python, Java, Excel (advanced formulas, charts); regression analysis (OLS), panel data, data cleaning
Languages: Russian (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)